MULTILEVEL · CEFR · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

ARTI-CLES









10

B2 readings with glossary



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ARTICLE 01 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

GREEN PACKAGING

Companies are currently in a race to develop eco-friendly packaging. While packaging plays a crucial role in modern marketing, much of it poses a threat to our planet.

01

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Companies are currently in a race to develop **eco-friendly packaging**. While packaging plays a crucial role in modern marketing, much of it **poses a threat** to our planet. This is mainly because producing packaging consumes vast amounts of energy, and once it becomes waste, materials like cartons and wrappers are often difficult to **dispose of properly**.

In many countries, people are increasingly aware of the damage that modern lifestyles are inflicting on the environment. Many are now **actively seeking** ways to protect the environment for future generations. As a result, politicians and scientists are seriously **looking into** energy conservation and waste management, aiming to make them more environmentally sustainable.

> *"Plastic goods and packaging create waste that is particularly challenging to eliminate.*

In the realm of packaging, it's essential that materials are either recyclable or biodegradable. For instance, rather than simply throwing newspapers and glass bottles into regular household waste, people in several countries are encouraged to use designated containers for recycling. Certain household waste, like vegetable peelings, is naturally biodegradable, meaning it **decomposes naturally** over time.

However, **man-made materials** are not so easily dealt with. Plastic goods and packaging create waste that is particularly challenging to eliminate. This leads to the need for enormous landfill sites where plastic waste is buried underground, potentially **causing problems** for future generations. This also means the waste is not being **repurposed**.

Industrial waste **presents a similar challenge**, as factory effluent often contains chemicals that can pollute water sources. Factory waste must be carefully monitored to prevent such pollution. It's important to **implement safety measures** to prevent this.

Technological advancements, including nuclear power, have further **exacerbated** the waste problem. The disposal of nuclear waste is particularly concerning due to its radioactivity, which **potentially endangers** life. This waste is a **severe hazard**.

The high standard of living enjoyed in many countries has led to a significant increase in waste production. This could have a **devastating impact** on the planet's ecology. There's no doubt that **decisive action** must be taken urgently to protect our environment from potential disaster. It's crucial to **promote sustainable practices** to ensure a healthier future for all.

Glossary

01 **eco-friendly packaging**
Packaging that is designed to be environmentally responsible and sustainable

02 **poses a threat**
Represents a danger or risk

03 **dispose of properly**
To get rid of something in the correct and safe way, especially waste

04 **actively seeking**
Making a strong and deliberate effort to find or obtain something

05 **looking into**
Investigating or examining something

06 **decomposes naturally**
Breaks down into simpler substances by natural processes

07 **man-made materials**
Materials that are created by humans, not found in nature

08 **causing problems**
Creating difficulties or issues

09 **repurposed**
Used for a different purpose than originally intended

10 **presents a similar challenge**
Poses a comparable difficulty or problem

11 **implement safety measures**
To put safety precautions or actions into effect

12 **exacerbated**
Made worse or more severe

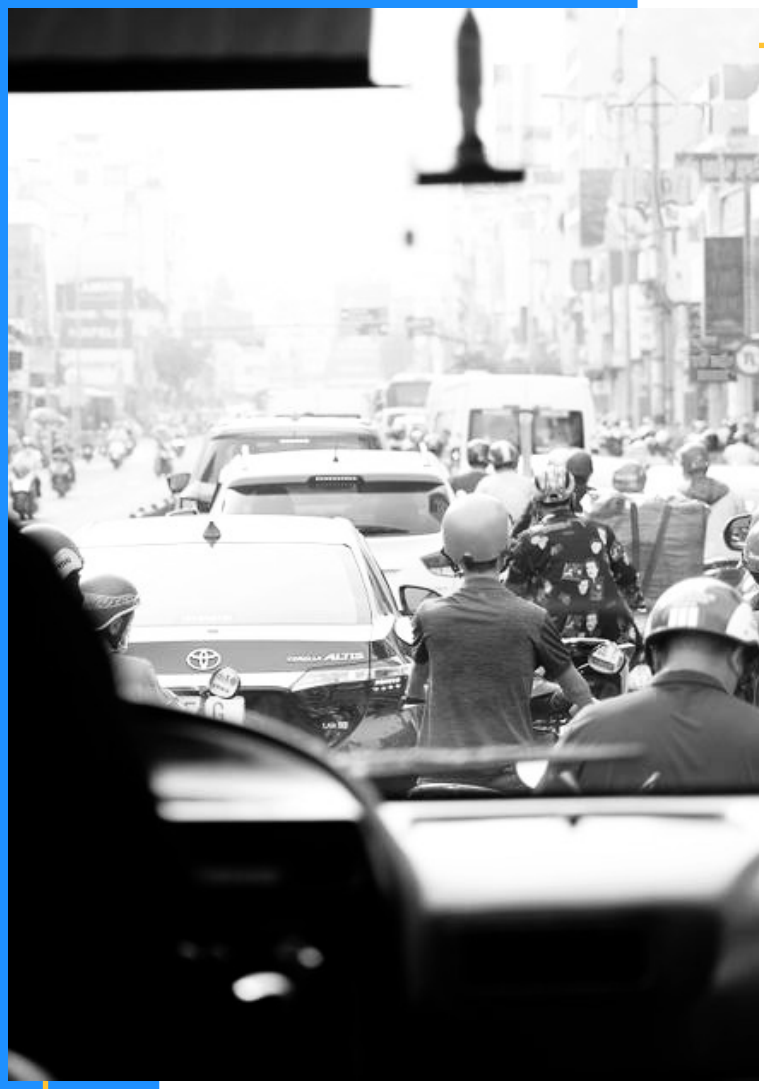
13 **potentially endangers**
Has the possibility of putting someone or something at risk

14 **severe hazard**
A very serious danger or risk

15 **devastating impact**
Extremely destructive or damaging effect

16 **decisive action**
Firm and determined action that is likely to be effective

17 **promote sustainable practices**
To encourage and support methods that can be maintained over time without harming the environment



ARTICLE 02 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

TOO MUCH TRAFFIC

Many of the challenges facing governments today are global in nature. A prime example is traffic congestion.

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Many of the challenges facing governments today are global in nature. A prime example is traffic congestion. Major cities worldwide are struggling to **devise solutions** for the ever-increasing number of vehicles and the resulting road congestion. This issue demands attention and innovative strategies.

A significant contributor to urban traffic is the prevalence of private cars. Despite persistent traffic jams, many drivers are **hesitant to abandon** their vehicles and opt for public transportation. They often view buses, trams, and trains as alternatives for others, preferring the convenience of door-to-door driving. Consequently, our roads are frequently **gridlocked** with traffic.

> *Otherwise law-abiding citizens sometimes take liberties when it comes to traffic regulations.*

Naturally, finding parking can be a challenge. While some companies provide parking facilities for their employees, most people must rely on public car parks, often multi-story structures, or attempt to park on the street. Given the often **stringent restrictions** and abundance of parking meters, finding a space becomes a source of frustration for many drivers. This situation often leads to stress and wasted time.

Otherwise law-abiding citizens sometimes **take liberties** when it comes to traffic regulations. They may disregard 'NO PARKING' signs or painted lines indicating parking restrictions. Even if they exceed the time limit on a parking meter, they might not worry – until they find a parking ticket on their windshield and realize they face a fine. This behavior highlights the temptation to bend the rules when convenience is at stake.

To address this, authorities in numerous cities are attempting to **discourage car use** in city centers. They have pedestrianized large areas and implemented park-and-ride schemes, encouraging people to leave their cars on the city outskirts and complete their journey by bus. These measures aim to reduce traffic volume in the most congested areas.

Despite these efforts, there are concerns that escalating traffic levels will cause complete **standstills** in cities, especially during rush hour. With frequent tailbacks and **bottlenecks** on numerous roads, driving is no longer an enjoyable experience. This raises the question: why do so many of us **persist in using** our cars, even when faced with these inconveniences? Perhaps it's time to **re-evaluate our reliance on** personal vehicles and explore alternative modes of transportation.

Glossary

01 **devise solutions**
To create or think of a plan or method for solving a problem

02 **hesitant to abandon**
Reluctant to give up or leave something behind

03 **gridlocked**
A situation where traffic is so heavy that no movement is possible

04 **stringent restrictions**
Strict and severe limitations or rules

05 **take liberties**
To act with freedom that exceeds what is allowed or appropriate

06 **discourage car use**
To try to persuade people not to use cars

07 **standstills**
A situation in which all movement or activity has stopped

08 **bottlenecks**
A place where a road or passage is narrow or blocked, causing traffic to slow down or stop

09 **persist in using**
To continue to use something despite difficulties or problems

10 **re-evaluate our reliance on**
To think again about how much we depend on something



BULLYING



ARTICLE 03 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

Education plays a crucial role in a child's development, yet a growing number of students are reluctant to attend school.

03

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Education plays a crucial role in a child's development, yet a growing number of students are **reluctant** to attend school. This isn't always due to academic difficulties or fear of teachers. Instead, many children are experiencing bullying, which can have a devastating impact on their well-being.

Bullying in schools can take many forms, making victims' lives incredibly difficult. Bullies often **exploit** their physical advantage to intimidate smaller or weaker students. They might threaten violence if their demands aren't met, often resorting to physical force to **extort** money or steal possessions. This creates a climate of fear and insecurity for the targeted individuals.

> *Some psychologists suggest that a bully's desire to dominate others stems from their own feelings of insecurity or personal unhappiness.*

Verbal abuse is also a common tactic employed by bullies. Victims are often targeted for being different in some way. This could be anything from having red hair or wearing glasses to not owning the latest clothes or having a different family structure. These perceived differences can make them a **prime target** for bullies, who may engage in hurtful name-calling and other forms of verbal harassment. These attacks can be **deeply damaging** to a child's self-esteem and confidence.

Some psychologists suggest that a bully's desire to dominate others stems from their own feelings of **insecurity** or personal unhappiness. While this might offer some insight into the bully's motivations, it doesn't lessen the pain and suffering experienced by the victims. The problem is so **prevalent** that many schools have been forced to develop formal policies to address it. These policies often include clear guidelines for reporting and addressing bullying incidents.

Teachers encourage students to report bullying, but many victims are afraid to come forward, fearing further **retaliation** or increased harassment. Bullies may accuse them of being "tattletales" and make their lives even more miserable. Furthermore, bullies can often be **deceptive**, appearing charming and well-behaved to adults while **tormenting** their peers. This makes it difficult to gather evidence and hold them accountable for their actions.

Because reporting bullying can be challenging, and proving it is often difficult, many bullies **evade** punishment. It is essential that we protect children from this form of **persecution**. They have the right to feel safe and secure at school and to enjoy their education without fear. Schools must work to create a **supportive environment** where bullying is not tolerated, and victims feel empowered to speak out and seek help. **Raising awareness** and promoting empathy are key steps in preventing bullying and fostering a more inclusive and respectful school community.

Glossary

01 **reluctant**
Unwilling and hesitant; disinclined.

02 **exploit**
To make full use of and derive benefit from (a resource).

03 **extort**
To obtain (something) by force, threats, or other unfair means.

04 **insecurity**
The state of being open to danger or threat; lack of protection.

05 **prime target**
Someone or something that is very likely to be attacked or criticized.

06 **deeply damaging**
Causing serious harm or injury to someone or something.

07 **prevalent**
Widespread in a particular area or at a particular time; common.

08 **retaliation**
Action taken in return for an injury or wrong; revenge.

09 **deceptive**
Giving an appearance or impression different from the true one; misleading.

10 **tormenting**
Inflicting severe physical or mental suffering on.

11 **evade**
To escape or avoid, especially by cleverness or trickery.

12 **persecution**
Hostile or ill-treatment, especially because of race or political or religious beliefs.

13 **supportive environment**
An atmosphere that provides encouragement and assistance.

14 **raising awareness**
The act of increasing public knowledge and understanding of an issue.

04



ARTICLE 04 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

GROWING OLD

Growing old is an inevitable part of life, something we all face despite our best efforts to postpone it.

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Growing old is an inevitable part of life, something we all face despite our best efforts to **postpone** it. While cosmetic procedures like surgery and hair dye can temporarily mask the signs of ageing, they can't stop the clock. Medical advancements have certainly helped people live longer, but the focus should be on maintaining a good **quality of life** as we age. The ageing process affects everyone differently; some remain healthy and independent well into old age, while others require support earlier.

One of the most challenging aspects of ageing is the potential decline in mental sharpness. It's common for older individuals to experience short-term memory loss, even while easily recalling distant memories. In some cases, this can **progress to** dementia, often in the form of Alzheimer's disease, a condition that gradually worsens over time. However, it's important to remember that this isn't the case for all older people.

> *"This type of discrimination, known as ageism, often leads to older individuals being unfairly labelled as frail and unproductive.*

Many senior citizens maintain their mental **faculties** and view retirement as a chance to enjoy newfound freedom. Those with good pensions may even find themselves financially comfortable, able to **indulge in** holidays and other luxuries. As a result, businesses and governments are increasingly aware of the economic and social influence of older people, often referred to as the "**grey market**".

Unfortunately, respect for older people isn't universal. While some cultures are known for their **veneration** of elders, in many societies, older people are **relegated to** a low status and treated accordingly. This type of discrimination, known as **ageism**, often leads to older individuals being unfairly labelled as **frail** and unproductive. Those who hold such views should remember that ageing is a universal experience and that they too will one day be in the same position. It is important to **foster** a society where older people are valued and respected for their wisdom and experience, not **dismissed** because of their age. We should strive to create inclusive environments where everyone can **age with dignity**. This includes ensuring access to appropriate healthcare, social support, and opportunities for continued learning and engagement. By **challenging stereotypes** and promoting intergenerational understanding, we can build a more equitable and supportive society for all.

Glossary

01 **postpone**
To delay something until a later time.

02 **quality of life**
The standard of health, comfort, and happiness experienced by an individual or group.

03 **progress to**
To move forward to a later or more advanced stage.

04 **faculties**
Inherent mental or physical powers.

05 **indulge in**
To allow oneself to enjoy the pleasure of.

06 **grey market**
The market consisting of older people, especially those who are retired or semi-retired.

07 **veneration**
Great respect; reverence.

08 **relegated to**
To assign to a lower rank or position.

09 **ageism**
Prejudice or discrimination on the basis of a person's age.

10 **frail**
Weak and delicate.

11 **foster**
To encourage the development of something.

12 **dismissed**
To treat as unworthy of serious consideration.

13 **age with dignity**
To grow old in a way that maintains respect and self-worth.

14 **challenging stereotypes**
Actively questioning and disputing widely held beliefs about certain groups of people.

PARENTAL ASPIRATIONS





In today's world, educational qualifications are widely considered paramount. They are almost essential for securing well-paid jobs in professional fields.

05

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In today's world, educational qualifications are widely considered **paramount**. They are almost essential for securing well-paid jobs in professional fields. Consequently, most parents try to encourage their children to study diligently and achieve academic success by performing well in exams. Many parents also **aspire** for their children to attend university and graduate with a respectable degree.

However, not all children have the **aptitude** for academic success. This is perfectly acceptable, provided parents can accept it. Unfortunately, it's common for parents to believe that hard work alone guarantees exam success. Too often, they simply create excessive stress for their children, potentially leading to illness or exam failure that could have been avoided. This can **undermine** their children's confidence and well-being.

> *"Each generation tends to have different perspectives, making communication between them incredibly challenging.*

Some children may be intelligent but simply lack interest in traditional schooling. They might possess an artistic **inclination**, wishing to become artists or designers, or they might have a talent for acting. Others may demonstrate a **knack** for practical work or a desire to start their own businesses and become entrepreneurs. It's entirely possible for children to **fulfil** these ambitions. However, their parents may have different ideas, which can cause family conflict. Interestingly, many parents are **hesitant** to let their children follow in their own footsteps. For instance, actors might discourage their children from pursuing a career in theatre due to the **precarious** nature of the profession. Business owners might believe their children would gain more prestige in an academic field than in the business world.

The opposite situation also occurs. Parents who have worked hard to establish a business might want their children to join it, only to find that their children prefer entirely different careers. This can lead to **disappointment** and **misunderstanding**. Each generation tends to have different perspectives, making communication between them incredibly challenging. This is the **genesis** of what is commonly known as the generation gap, a **phenomenon** that can strain family relationships. Bridging this gap requires **empathy** and a willingness to understand each other's viewpoints, allowing children to **pursue** their own paths while maintaining strong family bonds and **mutual respect**.

Glossary

01 **paramount**
More important than anything else; supreme.

02 **aspire**
To have a strong desire to achieve something.

03 **aptitude**
A natural ability to do something.

04 **undermine**
To gradually weaken or destroy something.

05 **inclination**
A feeling that makes a person want to do something; a tendency.

06 **knack**
A natural skill or talent.

07 **fulfil**
To achieve something desired, promised, or predicted.

08 **hesitant**
Unsure or slow in acting or speaking.

09 **precarious**
Not securely held or in danger of falling or collapsing.

10 **disappointment**
The feeling of sadness or dissatisfaction caused by the non-fulfillment of one's hopes or expectations.

11 **misunderstanding**
A failure to understand something correctly.

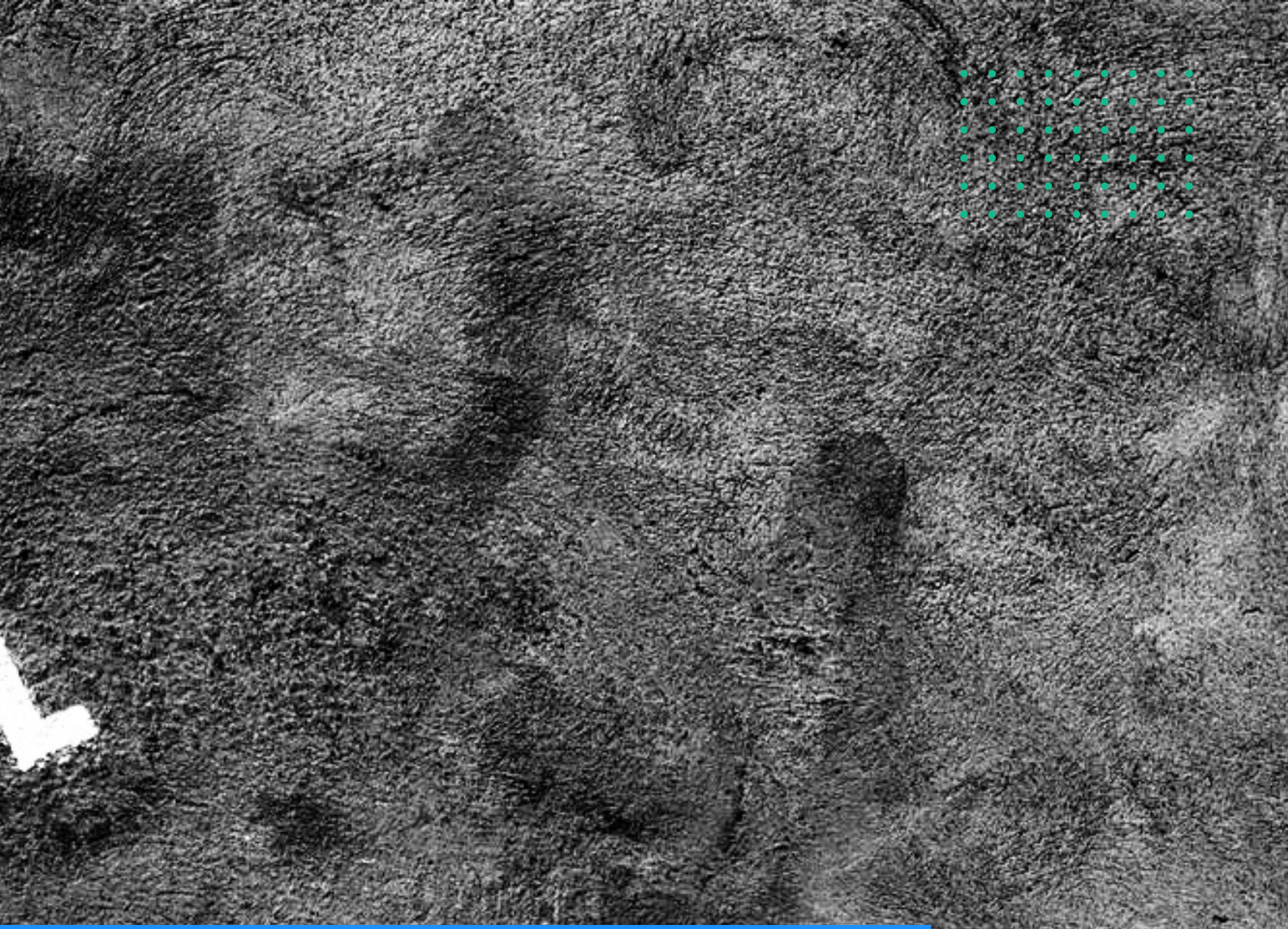
12 **genesis**
The origin or mode of formation of something.

13 **phenomenon**
A fact or situation that is observed to exist or happen, especially one whose cause or explanation is in question.

14 **empathy**
The ability to understand and share the feelings of another.

15 **pursue**
To follow or chase (someone or something).

16 **mutual respect**
Respect that two or more people feel for each other.



ARTICLE 06 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

DISCRIMINATION AGAINST DISABILITY

It's easy to fall into the trap of discriminating against people with disabilities, sometimes without even realising it.

06

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It's easy to **fall into the trap of** discriminating against people with disabilities, sometimes without even realising it. Often, able-bodied individuals **unintentionally patronise** those with disabilities, treating them like children. For instance, instead of asking a wheelchair user directly what they'd like to drink, someone might ask their companion, **effectively ignoring** the person in the wheelchair. Even when disabled people are clearly independent and travelling alone, they can be made to feel invisible, as if they **don't warrant** basic consideration. People may simply push past them without a second glance.

> *Many disabled people are perfectly capable of living independently at home.*

Naturally, disabled people have the same desires and interests as everyone else. They want to visit cultural attractions like museums and art galleries, eat out at restaurants, and generally participate in public life. However, **gaining access** to these places can present significant challenges. Public buildings often have steps at the entrance, which **pose a considerable obstacle** for wheelchair users. While some buildings now offer ramps, making access easier, this isn't always the case.

Narrow doorways can also be difficult to **manoeuvre through** for wheelchair users. Even after entering a building, further difficulties may arise. In older buildings, the only way to reach different floors might be a flight of stairs. Even if a lift is available, it might be too small to accommodate a wheelchair. Modern buildings are generally better equipped, usually featuring reasonably spacious lifts and escalators, which **significantly improve accessibility** for disabled people.

Many disabled people are perfectly capable of living independently at home. They might have a lift installed to access different floors, and a range of specially adapted appliances to help them manage everyday tasks. However, the moment they venture outside, they encounter a **multitude of barriers** that hinder their ability to live a normal life. Society must make every effort to **remove these barriers**. While some progress has been made in providing facilities for people with disabilities, much more needs to be done. Failure to do so risks **perpetuating ableism** and further marginalising this group.

Glossary

01 **fall into the trap of**
To unintentionally do something negative or make a mistake.

02 **unintentionally patronise**
To treat someone in a way that appears friendly, but which shows that you think you are better or more intelligent than them; without meaning to.

03 **effectively ignoring**
Having the same result as if you were ignoring someone, even if that wasn't your intention.

04 **don't warrant**
Not deserving or needing something.

05 **gaining access**
The act of being able to enter or use something.

06 **pose a considerable obstacle**
To create a significant problem or difficulty.

07 **manoeuvre through**
To carefully guide or direct something or someone in order to move or position them in a certain way, especially in a difficult situation.

08 **significantly improve accessibility**
To make something much easier to access or use.

09 **multitude of barriers**
A very large number of things that prevent something from happening or someone from progressing.

10 **remove these barriers**
To get rid of the things that are stopping someone from doing something or progressing.

11 **perpetuating ableism**
Continuing to support discrimination and prejudice against people with disabilities.



ARTICLE 07 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

FOOTBALL HOOLIGANS

As football fever grips the world once again, the qualifying rounds for major tournaments like the World Cup are in full swing.

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As football fever grips the world once again, the qualifying rounds for major tournaments like the World Cup are in full swing. The sport's global **appeal** is undeniable, and these matches generate considerable excitement. At the club level, weekly games draw huge crowds, with fans **flocking** to stadiums, both home and away, hoping for a victory. The ideal match, in their eyes, is an **attacking** one, filled with goals and excitement. A dull, defensive game with endless, pointless passing is the last thing they want to see.

Unfortunately, the action isn't always confined to the pitch. All too often, **unruly** behaviour spills over into the stands. Football supporters, easily identifiable by their team's colours displayed on scarves and shirts, are known for their passionate, and sometimes **boisterous**, behaviour. They enthusiastically cheer on their team, singing loud, often partisan songs.

> *When trouble erupts within a football crowd, it can be extremely difficult to control.*

While rivalry between supporters is a natural part of the game, and mostly **harmless**, it can quickly escalate into something more serious. Fans can become enraged by perceived injustices, such as a referee's decision to issue an unfair card or **overlook** a foul committed by the opposing team. Such incidents can **ignite** tensions and lead to conflict.

When trouble **erupts** within a football crowd, it can be extremely difficult to control. Stadium authorities frequently segregate opposing fans in different sections of the ground as a preventative measure. However, managing potential conflict outside the stadium is even more challenging. In extreme cases, the police, sometimes in riot gear, are called in to **restore order**.

Sadly, a minority of fans actively seek out violence. These football hooligans see the game as an excuse for causing trouble, relishing clashes with the police and **inciting** others to throw objects. They view football not as a sport, but as an opportunity for **mayhem**. Their behaviour inevitably **tarnishes** the image of the game and **undermines** the enjoyment of genuine fans. Law enforcement agencies are constantly working to **clamp down on** such behaviour and ensure the safety of everyone attending football matches, striving to maintain the sport's positive reputation and **safeguard** the experience for all.

Glossary

01 **appeal**
the quality of being attractive or interesting

02 **flocking**
to go to a place or area, usually in large numbers

03 **attacking**
used to describe a style of play in sports that is intended to score goals or points

04 **unruly**
difficult to control or discipline

05 **boisterous**
noisy, energetic, and cheerful

06 **harmless**
not able or likely to cause harm

07 **overlook**
to fail to notice something

08 **ignite**
to cause a dangerous, excited, or angry situation to begin

09 **erupts**
to start suddenly and violently

10 **restore order**
to bring back a situation in which people obey the law

11 **inciting**
to encourage someone to do something violent, illegal, or unpleasant

12 **mayhem**
violent or damaging disorder; chaos

13 **tarnishes**
to spoil or damage something's reputation

14 **undermines**
to make someone or something weaker or less effective

15 **clamp down on**
to take strong action to stop something

16 **safeguard**
to protect someone or something from harm or damage

TRAVEL TROUBLES



ARTICLE 08 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

More and more people seem to be jetting off abroad for their holidays each year. However, this also means that an increasing number of travellers are facing the inevitable stresses and disappointments that can come with...

08

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More and more people seem to be **jetting off** abroad for their holidays each year. However, this also means that an increasing number of travellers are facing the **inevitable** stresses and disappointments that can come with international travel. The problems often begin at the airport, regardless of which airline you're flying with.

Especially during peak season, you're **virtually guaranteed** to encounter long queues at check-in, followed by further delays at passport control before you can even reach the departure lounge. Then, there's the often **agonising** experience of flight delays. While these are more likely with charter flights, scheduled flights are by no means **immune**. These delays can be caused by technical problems or the sheer volume of aircraft taking off and landing. However, in Europe, at least, some are due to **industrial action** by airport staff. Unfortunately, the holiday season is often a popular time for baggage handlers, air traffic controllers, or other airport employees to **take industrial action**.

> *With the sheer amount of luggage carried on planes, it's unfortunately quite common for bags to go missing.*

Despite these potential **setbacks**, you eventually make it to the departure gate, board the plane, find your seat, and buckle up, ready for take-off. The cabin crew will probably serve you food and drinks, and unless you're on a long-haul flight, the journey will seem relatively short before you land.

Upon arrival, you need to follow the signs to the baggage reclaim area and wait by the carousel for your luggage, hoping it hasn't been **mislaid** or sent to the wrong destination. With the sheer amount of luggage carried on planes, it's unfortunately quite common for bags to go missing. Luckily, this is usually a temporary situation. Luggage is tagged, making it relatively easy for airlines to track it down. Still, it's always a relief to be **reunited with** your belongings! It's an even greater relief to arrive home safe and sound, leaving us to **ponder** whether the trip was worth the effort. However, next year will almost certainly find us back at the airport, ready for another adventure, **come what may**.

Glossary

01 **jetting off**
Going on a trip by airplane

02 **inevitable**
Certain to happen; unavoidable

03 **virtually guaranteed**
Almost certain to happen

04 **agonising**
Causing great physical or mental pain

05 **immune**
Not affected by something

06 **industrial action**
Measures taken by workers to protest against employers

07 **take industrial action**
To participate in a strike or other form of protest against an employer

08 **setbacks**
A problem that delays or prevents progress, or makes things worse than they were

09 **mislaid**
To lose something temporarily by forgetting where you have put it

10 **reunited with**
Brought back together with someone or something

11 **ponder**
To think carefully about something, especially for a noticeable amount of time

12 **come what may**
Whatever happens



09



ARTICLE 09 · B2 UPPER-INTERMEDIATE

NEW RESEARCH ON COMPUTER GAMES

A recent study by a Japanese professor has unearthed evidence suggesting that computer games might negatively impact children.

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A recent study by a Japanese professor has **unearthed evidence** suggesting that computer games might negatively impact children. While many parents and grandparents have voiced similar concerns for years, they've often been **dismissed as** technologically resistant. These worries often **revolve around** the potential effects on children's physical health and social development.

Parents often feel that children should be outdoors, exercising and socialising with friends. Instead, many children play alone, leading to **social isolation** and limited opportunities for interaction, which can **hinder their communication skills**. There's also the concern that the violent content in many games could **desensitise children** to violence and potentially lead to more aggressive behaviour, a fear also associated with exposure to violent content on television.

> *"Using advanced technology, his research aims to demonstrate that computer games may impair brain development in children.*

Moreover, some worry that the **pervasiveness** of computer games contributes to a **general decline in** the complexity and depth of information that young people engage with. Because children may choose gaming over reading or homework, these games are thought to **impede their academic progress**. Parents are also concerned that excessive screen time might **stifle creativity**, preventing children from engaging in activities like drawing or writing.

Professor Ryuta Kawashima from Tohoku University shares these concerns about the **potential adverse effects** of computer games, but his research offers a more scientific perspective. Using advanced technology, his research **aims to demonstrate** that computer games may **impair brain development** in children.

His brain scans indicate that gaming primarily stimulates areas of the brain related to vision and movement. Crucially, the frontal lobes, which are **instrumental in** learning, memory, emotional regulation, and self-control, show **signs of underdevelopment**. If children's ability to control their behaviour is indeed being compromised, they might be more **prone to** aggressive outbursts. Professor Kawashima's research seems to **substantiate** parental fears about the potential downsides of computer games.

Glossary

01 **unearthed evidence**
Discovered proof or information that was previously hidden or unknown

02 **dismissed as**
Rejected or regarded as not worthy of consideration

03 **revolve around**
To be mainly concerned with or centered on something

04 **social isolation**
A state of complete or near-complete lack of contact between a person and society.

05 **hinder their communication skills**
To make it difficult for someone to develop or improve their ability to communicate effectively

06 **desensitise children**
To make someone less likely to feel shocked or upset by something, especially violence

07 **pervasiveness**
The quality of spreading widely throughout an area or group of people.

08 **general decline in**
A decrease or deterioration in something overall.

09 **impede their academic progress**
To delay or prevent someone's advancement in education.

10 **stifle creativity**
To suppress or prevent the development of creativity.

11 **potential adverse effects**
Possible negative or harmful consequences.

12 **aims to demonstrate**
Intends to show or prove something clearly.

13 **impair brain development**
To damage or weaken the growth and maturation of the brain.

14 **instrumental in**
Important in causing something to happen.

15 **signs of underdevelopment**
Indications that something is not growing or developing properly.

16 **prone to**
Likely to experience or suffer from something.

17 **substantiate**
To provide evidence to support or prove the truth of.



ARTICLE 10 · B2

TERRORISM



The world was horrified by the terrible acts of terrorism in the United States. These actions have been rightly condemned by leaders worldwide, who see such terrorist activities as a serious threat to...

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The world was **horrified** by the terrible acts of terrorism in the United States. These actions have been rightly condemned by leaders worldwide, who see such terrorist activities as a **serious threat** to democracy and a **grave crime** against the American people.

> *The United States invests heavily in defence and intelligence.*

Terrorist acts are often **deliberately designed** to gain maximum publicity for the cause the terrorists support. The terrorists who crashed planes into the World Trade Center in New York certainly achieved **widespread attention**. The second plane attack was even broadcast live on television news channels around the globe, capturing the moment of impact.

The desire to **publicise their aims** usually leads terrorist groups to claim responsibility for acts of violence. However, immediately after the attack on America, no group **stepped forward** to take responsibility. Also, terrorist attacks on civilian targets often include some kind of warning. This **was not the case** in New York, and thousands of innocent people lost their lives.

The United States invests heavily in defence and intelligence. Yet, the country was completely **taken by surprise** by this attack. Many Americans had believed their powerful nation was **invulnerable** and were deeply shocked that terrorists could **breach their security** in such a way.

There are many different terrorist groups around the world, each **driven by** different motivations. These might include a feeling of political injustice, religious **zeal**, or simply hatred for those they attack. They are often a **hidden enemy**, using **secrecy** to commit brutal acts, and then disappearing without a trace.

The most difficult terrorists to deal with are those who are prepared to die for their cause. Their **fanatical hatred** of their targets means they are willing to commit suicide to inflict casualties on the enemy. World leaders now understand the global nature of many modern issues. The need to **eliminate terrorism** is, without doubt, one of the most important.

Glossary

01 **horrified**
Extremely shocked and disgusted

02 **serious threat**
A grave danger or risk

03 **grave crime**
A very serious offense

04 **deliberately designed**
Intentionally planned and created

05 **widespread attention**
Attracting a lot of notice from many people

06 **publicise their aims**
To make their goals widely known

07 **stepped forward**
Volunteered or came forward to take action or responsibility

08 **was not the case**
It wasn't like that

09 **taken by surprise**
Caught unexpectedly

10 **invulnerable**
Impossible to harm or damage

11 **breach their security**
To break through or violate their safety measures

12 **driven by**
Motivated or caused by

13 **zeal**
Great energy or enthusiasm in pursuit of a cause or objective

14 **hidden enemy**
An opponent whose identity is concealed

15 **secrecy**
The state of being kept secret

16 **fanatical hatred**
Extreme and irrational dislike

17 **eliminate terrorism**
To completely remove or get rid of terrorism